

INFORMATION FOR FAMILIES

INNOVATING FUTURE LEADERS

Plato School

Pre-Medical Programme

The pre-medical undergraduate years, taught in Seoul, for students who intend to apply to medical, dental or veterinary school in the United States.

\$30,000 a year in tuition, against roughly \$100,000 all-in at an American private university.

A programme of a 501(c)(3) non-profit foundation incorporated in California, 2023

Seoul, Republic of Korea

plato-school.vercel.app

Please read the final page before you decide anything. Plato is preparing its first cohort. Several things parents normally take for granted are not yet in place, and we would rather you learn that from us than discover it later.

THE PROBLEM

Why this school exists

An American private university now costs close to \$100,000 a year once tuition, room and board are counted. Four years is \$400,000. Two children is \$800,000.

Families just above the financial aid threshold carry that number in full. On paper they can afford it. In practice almost none of them can, and the gap is closed with debt.

American higher education treats the student as a beneficiary rather than a customer. A customer has price points. A beneficiary takes what is offered and borrows the difference. The middle price point does not exist.

What four years actually costs

	US private university	Plato School
Tuition	\$65,000 / yr	\$30,000 / yr
Room and board	\$20,000 / yr	about \$12,000 / yr in Seoul
Books, insurance, travel	\$15,000 / yr	varies
Four years	about \$400,000	about \$168,000

Tuition is set in dollars and is not raised retroactively for enrolled students. The figure you are quoted on entry is the figure you plan against.

And the part that is not about money

Most American pre-medical students finish four years having never lived or worked outside the United States. On a medical school application that is a box which stays empty, and in a career it is a gap that closes slowly.

The next thirty years of medicine, research and industry will not be settled in one hemisphere. Knowing both East and West has stopped being enrichment. It is becoming a qualification.

What your child studies

Three to four undergraduate years covering every prerequisite American medical schools require, taught in English by US faculty alongside resident instructors in Seoul.

Prerequisites, in full

Admissions committees care less about the name on a transcript than whether the prerequisites were completed. Biology, chemistry, organic chemistry, physics, biochemistry, psychology, sociology and statistics are all built in to AMCAS standards.

Five ways out, not one

A student who does not reach an MCAT threshold is not left without a route. The same curriculum opens five paths.

Graduate path	Typical requirement
MD — medical school	MCAT 510+
DO — osteopathic medicine	MCAT 500-509
Dental school	DAT 20+
Veterinary school	GRE optional
Oriental medicine (US graduate programmes)	No entrance examination

Preparation beyond coursework

- **MCAT** — diagnostic testing, an individual study plan and full-length practice examinations across two years
- **Application** — AMCAS strategy, the personal statement, and rehearsal of the MMI interview format used by roughly 60% of North American medical schools
- **School list** — there are 155 MD schools in the United States; we tier those realistically open to each applicant rather than applying broadly

Why the city matters

Cheap cities are common. Cheap cities with a world-class hospital cluster, a pharmaceutical industry, an AI sector and a semiconductor industry are not.

Clinical observation

Classrooms sit beside the Gangnam and Seocho medical cluster, so clinical hours fit into the academic week rather than around it.

Research

Routes into co-authorship on medical papers and conference presentation, which is what the AMCAS activities section is really asking for.

Industry

Pharmaceutical, biotech, AI and semiconductor firms within reach for visits and exposure.

What students may and may not do

Students observe consultations under the supervision of the attending physician and review cases with them.

We state the limit plainly. Article 27 of the Korean Medical Service Act prohibits medical acts by unlicensed individuals. Students do not draw blood, administer injections, diagnose or prescribe. The activity is observation and learning, and we do not describe it as anything more.

Living in Seoul

There is no residential campus. Housing is arranged individually and we advise on options. Seoul is consistently ranked among the safest large cities in the world, and living costs run below an American college town.

PRACTICAL QUESTIONS

What parents ask first

Is teaching in English?

Yes. Core subjects, examinations and application essays are all in English. For applicants whose first language is not English we recommend TOEFL 90 or above.

Do students need a visa?

Arrangements depend on nationality and are reviewed individually before admission, not after. Korean nationals and ethnic Koreans abroad face no residency restriction.

Can a student apply to US medical school as a domestic applicant?

Students holding US citizenship or permanent residency remain domestic rather than international applicants, which materially improves their position.

How is GPA managed?

American medical schools read science GPA and overall GPA separately. Both are tracked through regular review and supplementary instruction, with targets set according to the schools a student is aiming at.

Are scholarships available?

Provision is being established for academically strong students and for those who need financial support. Current confirmed provision is explained during admissions conversations.

Is Plato right for every student?

No. A student without a solid English base, a student who cannot yet explain in their own words why they want to practise medicine, and a student whose goal is a Korean medical licence would each be better served elsewhere. Four years on the wrong route costs the student more than it costs us.

Where we actually are

Plato is preparing its first cohort. We would rather be direct about what is and is not in place.

In place

- A 501(c)(3) non-profit foundation incorporated in California in 2023, with finances disclosed annually through IRS Form 990
- The full curriculum, published as a 500-page volume on 22 May 2026 and available in Korean bookshops
- Documented legal structure for operating the programme in Korea

Not yet in place

- **Accreditation.** Plato is not an accrediting body, is not accredited by WSCUC, and has not applied for that accreditation.
- **The partner university agreement.** The intended structure is credit recognition by a WSCUC-accredited university in California, which would issue the transcript submitted to medical schools. That agreement is not signed. Until it is, the structure is an intention rather than a fact.
- **Enrolled students.** The first cohort has not started, and no start date is confirmed.

What this means for you. If you enquire now, we will tell you where things stand and let you decide once the credit structure is settled. **We do not ask for tuition before that point.**

Two things we are not

Plato is not a university under Korean higher education law and does not confer a Korean degree. It has no bearing on Korean medical licensure. It operates as an overseas educational programme of a US corporation — the same legal form American universities use to run programmes abroad.

Talking to us

Tell us where your child stands academically and what they are aiming at, and we will look at it with you honestly — including telling you if another route would serve them better.

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